

Singapore Polytechnic Institutional Review Board (SP IRB)

Guidelines for Research Involving Human Subjects

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1 INTRODUCTION

Human biomedical research (HBR) is ethically justifiable only if it abides by acceptable moral standards within the community. It should be carried out in ways that respect and protect the subjects of the research. The research must conform to generally accepted scientific principles and be based on a thorough knowledge of existing scientific literature and adequate laboratory skills. Scientifically invalid research is unethical, as it exposes research subjects to unwarranted risks without likely benefits. An independent ethics review committee serves as the gatekeeper to evaluate, guide, approve and monitor the research projects.

Singapore Polytechnic Institutional Review Board (SP IRB) has formulated Guidelines for Research Involving Human Subjects. SP IRB also has made recommendations on the operational guidelines, constitution and role of Institutional Review Board (IRB), in the ethics governance of human research and human biomedical research for SP as a research institution (RI).

2 BASIC ETHICAL PRINCIPLES

2.1 All HBR must be conducted in accordance with these three (3) fundamental ethical principles:

- a) **Respect for persons**, which incorporates at least two (2) basic ethical considerations:
 - i. Respect for autonomy, which requires that those who are capable of deliberation about their personal choices should be treated with respect for their capacity for self-determination;
 - ii. Protection of persons with impaired or diminished autonomy (such as children or the mentally disabled), which requires that those who are dependent or vulnerable be afforded additional security against harm or abuse.
- b) **Beneficence**, which refers to the ethical obligation to maximize benefits and to minimize harm. In the research context, it is unlikely that direct benefit will accrue to research subjects. Consequently, harm and discomfort to subjects must be minimised and the risks of research must be reasonable and justified in the light of the expected benefits. This entails a sound research design, and investigators competent both to conduct the research and to safeguard the welfare of the research subjects.
- c) **Justice**, which refers to the ethical obligation to treat each person in accordance with what is morally right and proper, and to give to each person what is due to him/her. Justice also requires that research be responsive to the health conditions or needs of vulnerable subjects. Accordingly, a researcher should:
 - i. avoid imposing on any particular group of individuals who are likely to be subjects of over-researching and unfair participation in research;
 - ii. ensure that the selection and recruitment of research subjects are fair; and
 - iii. be non-discriminatory, and not use race, age, gender, disability or religious beliefs for the selection and recruitment of actual or future participants, except where such exclusion or inclusion of particular groups is essential to the objective of the research.

- 2.2 Other important ethical principles include the respect for **free and informed consent**, and protection of **privacy and confidentiality**. Special attention must also be given to vulnerable persons, i.e., those with higher susceptibility to harms and/or with reduced ability to protect their rights and welfare, such as pregnant women, minors, elderlies, prisoners and the mentally incapacitated.

3 DEFINITIONS OF RESEARCH AND HUMAN BIOMEDICAL RESEARCH

- 3.1 “Research” is defined as any investigation designed to develop or contribute to generalisable knowledge. This generalisable knowledge will benefit specific groups, or the whole, of the human population, rather than any specific individual.
- 3.2 Human biomedical research (HBR) refers to any research on human subjects that is intended to study:
- a. the prevention, prognostication, diagnosis or alleviation of any disease, disorder or injury affecting the human body; or
 - b. the restoration, maintenance or promotion of the aesthetic appearance of human individuals through clinical procedures or techniques; or
 - c. the performance or endurance of human individuals,

where the research involves -

- i. subjecting an individual to any intervention (including any wilful act or omission) that has a physical, mental or physiological effect (whether temporary or permanent) on the body of the individuals; or
- ii. the use of any individually-identifiable human biological material obtained from the human body; or
- iii. the use of any individually-identifiable health information.

4 DETERMINING WHETHER A RESEARCH PROJECT NEEDS SP IRB REVIEW AND APPROVAL

In determining if a research project needs SP IRB review and approval, Principal Investigator (PI) should complete the “SP IRB Preliminary Review Form”, containing a synopsis of research project that clearly states the research objective(s)/hypothesis and methodology of the project. The SP IRB Preliminary Review Form should be signed by the PI, endorsed by the School/Department or Centre Director and must be submitted to SP IRB Secretariat.

Where it is determined by SP IRB that the research project involves more than minimal risk, the PI should complete the IRB Protocol Application Form and its prescribed associated documents, sign, and seek endorsement by School/Department or Centre Director before submitting to SP IRB Secretariat.

5 RESPONSIBILITIES OF PRINCIPAL INVESTIGATOR (PI)

The PI is the person primarily responsible for the conduct of the research project. If a team of individuals is involved in the conduct of the research project, the PI is responsible for the oversight of the research team. To qualify as a PI on a protocol submitted to the SP IRB, an individual must be a staff of SP. There may be 1 or more PIs for any given protocol. Non-SP staff may be listed as co-PIs or collaborators. For IRB protocol with collaborators, an official letter of collaboration needs to be submitted together with the protocol. Students who are under the supervision of SP lecturers/supervisors and are involved in designing or conducting the research project are not considered PIs of the research project, in such cases the PIs would be the SP lecturers/supervisors.

The rights, safety and well-being of the research subjects are of utmost importance, and the research proposal should demonstrate that there are adequate provisions to protect the rights, to ensure the safety and well-being of research subjects.

5.1 PI's Responsibility of Project Execution

The PI must adhere to the following with declarations:

- a) The PI will not initiate project until he or she has received notification of SP IRB approval (if applicable).
- b) The PI will not initiate any change in an approved protocol without prior written approval from the SP IRB except when it is necessary to reduce or eliminate immediate risk to the subjects.
- c) The PI will promptly report any unexpected or serious adverse events, unanticipated problems or incidents that occur in the course of the study.
- d) The PI will maintain all essential documents and recognise that SP IRB and/or other regulatory authorities may inspect these records.
- e) The PI understands that failure to comply with all applicable regulations, institutional & SP IRB policies and requirements may result in the suspension or termination of the project.
- f) The PI declares that there is no conflict of interest for any of the research personnel participating in the study, as well as their immediate family members. Should there be any conflict of interest, the PI must declare accordingly in the IRB Protocol Application Form and describe the plan to eliminate or manage the conflict of interest.

5.2 Qualifications and Adequate Resources

The PI should ensure that all PIs and Co-PIs are adequately trained in conducting human subject research by taking CITI online training at <https://www.citiprogram.org/>, as well as any additional training that is necessary for the safe and effective conduct of the research and/or as required by SP IRB upon its review of the protocol.

All the curriculum vitae (CV) and valid CITI programme certificates of the PIs and Co-PIs should be duly completed and submitted together with the IRB Protocol Application submission.

The PI should be thoroughly familiar with the research project protocol. The PI should have sufficient time and adequate qualified personnel to properly conduct and complete the research.

The PI should ensure that all persons assisting with the research are adequately informed about the protocol, the investigational products and their research-related duties.

5.3 Communication with SP IRB

The PI must obtain written approval from SP IRB or local IRB before initiating a research project involving human subjects, where the research is conducted or supervised by SP staff or conducted within SP premises.

For other human research in education, social science, or behaviour science, SP IRB approval ensures that the research project has been reviewed by an IRB of a research institution and may be a pre-requisite for publication in some peer-review journals. Please contact SP IRB Secretariat to find out more about the recommended procedures.

Records and Reports

The PI must maintain all essential project documents and recognize that the SP IRB and/or applicable regulatory authorities may inspect these documents. The PI must ensure the accuracy and completeness of data in all case report forms and project reports.

All research documents should be retained for at least 3 years after the project is completed as per SP's Record Management Policy (IM4). Thereafter, the data should be destroyed by the PI.

Change of PI and/or Project Team Members

If the PI is resigning from SP or is leave of absence for more than 3 months, the oversight of the research project should be formally delegated to another PI. The new PI should fulfil all qualifications for being a PI as per SP IRB requirements. The new PI will assume all the responsibilities as the PI for the conduct of the research project.

Any change in the PI or project team members should be documented via SP IRB Protocol Amendment Form. These changes should be reviewed and approved by SP IRB prior to implementation.

PI's Reporting Responsibilities

The PI is responsible for prompt reporting to SP IRB for the following situations when conducting a research project for an approved IRB protocol application:

- A) any modifications or amendments of administrative matters or experimental procedures (to raise an IRB Protocol Amendment Form),
- B) any expected or unexpected medical incident, which may lead to an adverse event, serious adverse event or non-serious adverse event or incidents involving risks to human subjects (to raise a Reporting Unexpected Serious Adverse Event (SAE) Form),

- C) any suspected offences or contraventions (to raise a Reporting Suspected Offence or Contravention (SOC) Form),
- D) for research project of duration longer than one year, to submit an Annual Progress Report at 13 months from the date of IRB protocol application approval (to raise an IRB Annual Progress or Final Report for IRB Approved Project Form),
- E) at the conclusion of the research project, to submit a Final Report within about 1 month from the end of research project (to raise an IRB Annual Progress or Final Report for IRB Approved Project Form), and
- F) any conflict of interest involving the PI, co-PI, or collaborator.

Besides the above situations, PI should report any ICT security incident, e.g., virus outbreaks, data loss, data breaches, etc to SPICE Service Desk or to school/department IT Chairman and inform SP IRB within 24 hours. Refer to section 9.4 for details.

5.4 Informed Consent of Research Subjects

The PI and/or research staff must recruit participants in a fair and equitable manner. For HBR projects, the investigator must ensure that potential benefits and risks are reasonably balanced and risks are minimized.

The PI must ensure that informed consent is obtained from subjects prior to their enrolment into the research. The PI must use the latest approved version of the Participant Information Sheet & Consent Form.

Please refer to sections 7.3 to 7.6 on informed consent process.

5.5 De-identification of Data

“Individually identifiable”, in relation to human biological material or health information pertaining to an individual, under Human Biomedical Research Act 2015 (HBRA), means that the individual can be identified (a) from the human biological material or health information; or (b) from that human biological material or health information to which the person, research institution, tissue bank or other organization has or is likely to have access.

PI who has obtained individually-identifiable information or human biological material for purposes of human biomedical research must take all reasonable steps and safeguards as may be necessary, including rendering information or material non-identifiable, to protect such information or material against accidental or unlawful loss, modification or destruction, or unauthorised access, disclosure, copying, use or modification. Data de-identification may be performed using enCRYPT (available online at <https://www.encrypt.gov.sg/>), which is a Central Privacy Toolkit for Singapore Public Sector.

Data de-identification policy

Data de-identification must be performed by the PI if the research involves obtaining individually identifiable information from the participants. PI should assign a member from his/ her team to

do the de-identification process. After the process, the master key linking individually-identifiable information to anonymised data should be stored by the PI with confidentiality to prevent unauthorized access, modification or disclosure.

5.6 Other Responsibilities of PI

- i) Ensuring that all resources and facilities necessary to protect the health and welfare of human participants are in place.
- ii) Retaining ultimate responsibility for conduct of the project. Other duties may be delegated only to those appropriately trained research staff who are approved by SP IRB to conduct those procedures on the specific protocol.
- iii) Conducting the research project according to (a) the most current IRB-approved protocol, including any IRB conditions for approval and (b) the IRB's SOPs. The PI must provide information about the project to the IRB, when requested. The PI must cease conduct of the project if the IRB suspends or terminates the protocol.
- iv) Using only participants from whom valid informed consent has been obtained. The PI will ensure that the most current, IRB-approved consent form/process is used.
- v) Ensuring that care for research-related injuries, or emotional or psychological distress, are available and clearly defined, along with appropriate contact information, in the Participant Information Sheet & Consent Form.
- vi) Maintaining complete records of documents such as protocol application participant information sheet, informed consent form, questionnaires, experimental data collected, including observations of unanticipated events.
- vii) Ensure that any human biological material obtained during the course of the project will be stored and analysed only for the purposes of the project for the approved period.
- viii) Ensure that all data collected to be filed securely and kept in locked cabinets for at least 3 years as per SP's Record Management Policy (IM4) after the project is completed. Thereafter, the data should be destroyed by the PI.

6 SUBMISSION REQUIREMENTS & PROCESSING OF SUBMISSIONS

6.1 Submission Procedures

A completed application for IRB review can be submitted to SP IRB Secretariat by the PI after obtaining endorsement by the School/ Department or Centre Director. The latest copy of the protocol application form can be found under the SP IRB page on SP Staff Portal.

6.2 Submission Requirements

- a) For preliminary review, please submit the SP IRB Preliminary Review Form.
- b) Full Board Review and Expedited Review: A complete IRB Protocol Application consists of 1 softcopy of IRB Protocol Application Form, Participant Information Sheet & Consent (PIS) Form, and all supporting documents as listed below. This list is not exhaustive. Please submit

those that are applicable to your research project. SP IRB may request for the necessary documents if there are missing ones.

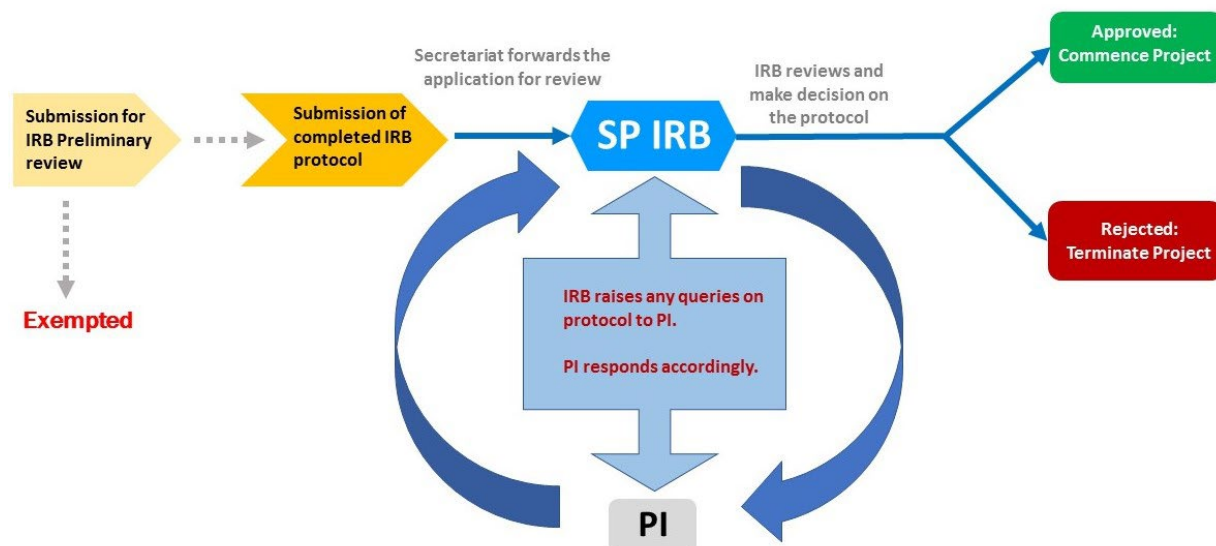
Documents that will be used in the study	Supporting documents
IRB Protocol Application Form	Grant application form
Participant Information Sheet (PIS) and Consent Form	Grant approval letter
Survey / Questionnaire / Interview guide	Investigators' CVs
Data collection form	CITI program certificates
Advertisement(s)	Subject payment details
Letter of invitation(s) for subjects	Relevant publications

- c) All relevant sections of the Protocol Application Form must be filled out completely, including signature from your School/Department or Centre Director. Please note that only completed application will be reviewed.
- d) All instructions red in colour in the Protocol Application Form and the PIS & Consent Form must be deleted prior to submission.
- e) SP IRB Secretariat may request for the original documents to be furnished for verification purposes at any time.
- f) The latest versions of the forms can be downloaded from IRB website on SP Staff Portal page.

Important: *The submitted IRB Application Form must be signed by the School/Department or Centre Director.*

6.3 Process after Submission

Each application may take 1 to 2 months for the entire review process to complete prior to approval.



Important: As the review process takes about 1 to 2 months, Principal investigators are strongly advised to prepare and submit their application 2 to 3 months before the intended commencement of the study.

6.4 SP Institutional Review Board Review

Preliminary review will be done to determine if an IRB review is required. All applications shall undergo full board review unless criteria for an expedited or exemption review are met.

All IRB applications received by the Secretariat will be processed within a 7 days' time period from the date of receipt of application. The time frame from submission to approval will vary depending on several factors such as the complexity of the project, completeness of the IRB submission, number of rounds of amendments of the application in response to the issues raised by SP IRB members, response time of PI to reviewers' comments, etc.

7 CRITERIA OF REVIEW

7.1 Scientific Design and Conduct of the Project

- A research project with little or no scientific merit, where the risks of discomfort or harm to subjects are not justified by the expected benefits, is ethically unacceptable. SP IRB, however, may not be responsible for carrying out the scientific review of research projects. It is for PI to provide to SP IRB all relevant findings, whether positive or negative, of the review for scientific merit, and to satisfy SP IRB that an objective review has been carried out.
- The scientific review of research projects may be carried out by such committees, bodies or agencies as SP IRB may, in its judgement, recognise as appropriate.
- SP IRB may rely on the scientific review carried out by the grant funding agency, on the provision that SP IRB make its own determination as to the objectivity and adequacy of the review that had been carried out. SP IRB should require a more extensive or rigorous scientific review, if deemed necessary.

7.2 Recruitment of Research Subjects

SP IRB should be satisfied that the selection of subjects is equitable, and that the means of establishing initial contact, manner of recruitment, and information to be conveyed to potential subjects (or their representatives), are acceptable.

7.3 Informed Consent Process

Informed consent should be obtained from all human subjects prior to their participation in any research. Informed consent is the process by which a subject voluntarily confirms his/her willingness to participate in a particular research project, after having been informed of all aspects of the research project that are relevant to his/her decision to participate. Informed consent is to be documented by means of a written, signed and dated informed consent form.

The informed consent process is necessary to ensure that subjects are fully informed before deciding whether to volunteer in research projects of any type. The following considerations should be kept in mind while conducting an informed consent discussion.

- a) Informed consent should be obtained before initiation of the project, i.e., before any procedures performed solely for research are carried out.
- b) Subjects must be given adequate time to consider before deciding whether or not to participate.
- c) Subjects should be encouraged to discuss participation with their family members.
- d) Subjects should be approached in an environment conducive for consent discussion.
- e) Informed consent should be taken by the PI or any qualified member of the study staff who is listed in the approved IRB Protocol Application as the designated person for conducting the informed consent discussion. Informed consent discussion should take place in person. Consent documents should not be mailed to subjects with instructions to call back with questions, or to sign and mail back.
- f) The informed consent discussion must be conducted in a language understandable by the subject.
- g) The informed consent must be obtained in the presence of a prescribed witness.
- h) The scanned softcopies or hardcopies of the signed consent forms should be retained by the PIs involved in the HBR project for at least 3 years after the end of the HBR project.

7.4 Requirements of Witness to Appropriate consent

Any appropriate consent must be taken in the presence of a witness;

- a) who is 21 years of age and older;
- b) who has mental capacity; and
- c) who must not be the same individual taking the appropriate consent.

The witness may be a member of the team carrying out the research of which the individual giving the consent is a research subject. The witness must take reasonable steps to ascertain;

1. the identity of the individual giving the appropriate consent; and
2. that the consent was given voluntarily without any coercion or intimidation.

The presence of a prescribed witness can be exempted where the research is not invasive, or does not subject any individual to any intervention that has a physical, mental or physiological effect (whether temporary or permanent) on the body of the individual.

7.5 Consent of Minors

In a research where the prospective subject is a minor (below 21 years of age), who has sufficient intelligence and understanding, the appropriate consent should be obtained from the minor and at least one adult parent or guardian of the minor.

7.6 Waiver of Appropriate Consent for the Use of Individually-Identifiable Information

SP IRB may waive the requirement to obtain appropriate consent, but such approval must be in accordance with HBRA in human biomedical research.

PIs may seek a waiver of appropriate consent from SP IRB where attempting to obtain consent or re-consent would impose such disproportionate burden to the PI such that the continual of research is not possible. Conditions under the 'Fifth Schedule of the HBRA' must be fulfilled for a waiver to be granted. SP IRB may waive the requirement for appropriate consent if IRB is satisfied that:

- a) the research cannot be reasonably carried out without the use of the Human Information (HI) and/or Human Biomedical Materials (HBM) in an individually-identifiable form;
- b) the process of obtaining consent from the person to which the HBM/HI relates will involve a disproportionate amount of effort and resources relative to the research requirements;
- c) the use of the individually-identifiable HI and/or HBM involves no more than minimal risk to the research subject;
- d) the waiver concerned will not otherwise adversely affect the rights and welfare of the research subject; and
- e) the HBR or HI research would reasonably be considered to contribute to the greater public good.

7.7 Care and Protection of Research Subjects

SP IRB should assess, amongst other factors:

- a) the previous training, qualifications and professional experience of the PI of the research project;
- b) the plans to withdraw or withhold the research project, and the justification for such action;
- c) medical care to be provided to research subjects during and after the course of the research project;
- d) the adequacy of medical supervision and support for the research subjects;
- e) the steps to be taken, if research subjects should choose to withdraw their participation in the research project before its completion; and

- f) the financial costs to research subjects.

7.8 Protection of Research Subject Privacy and Confidentiality

PI should be required to put in place adequate measures to protect the privacy and confidentiality of data concerning the research subjects, in accordance with all existing laws on data privacy and confidentiality.

7.9 Community/subject Considerations

SP IRB should consider in the review of a research project, its impact on, and relevance to, the local population, especially the communities from which the research subjects are to be drawn. Whether, and the manner in which, the results of the research project will be made available to the subjects, and the rest of the communities concerned, should also be reviewed.

7.10 Reimbursement and Compensation

SP IRB should be satisfied that the amount and method for payment and reimbursement to research subjects would not present problems of undue inducement or influence on the research subjects. SP IRB should ensure that the informed consent process/document does not contain any words that would absolve a researcher from responsibility in case of accidental injury, or that would imply that subjects waive their rights to seek compensation for injuries resulting from their participation in the research project. Research subjects should be informed of whether there are any provisions for compensation for injuries arising from their participation in the research.

8 NOTIFICATION OF APPROVAL

The PI will be notified via email of SP IRB's decision concerning approval of a submitted IRB application.

9 REPORTING TO SP IRB

9.1 Notification of Adverse Events (AEs) and Serious/ Non-Serious Adverse Events (SAEs)

For any expected or unexpected medical incidence, it may lead to adverse event, serious adverse event or non-serious adverse event.

- **Serious Adverse Event (SAE)** refers to death, in-patient hospitalisation, disability, congenital anomaly or other serious life-threatening events that occurred as a result of the human biomedical research.

- **Non-Serious Adverse Event (Non-SAEs)** refers to any unfavourable and unintended sign (including an abnormal laboratory finding), symptom, or disease associated with the participant in the human biomedical research.

Following the approval of the proposed project, the PI is obliged to notify SP IRB in any event such as:

1. Any expected or unexpected SAE should be reported to the SP IRB Secretariat within 24 hours with immediate corrective action undertaken.
2. Submission of the SAE reporting form, additional details and relevant information to SP IRB within 3 days after notification.
3. Any expected or unexpected Non-SAEs should be reported to SP IRB Secretariat within 30 days.

PIs can download the SAE Reporting form from SP IRB Staff Portal page and submit the completed form to SP IRB via irb@sp.edu.sg. SP Principal Person In Charge (PPIC) and Chairman/Co-Chairman of SP IRB will review the safety of the project and a detailed report will be sent to MOH within 7 days from the notification date. The detailed reports with the annual study report of all AEs and SAEs will be filed in the SP AE/SAE log. Refer to Flowchart for Reporting SAEs/SOCs at page 16.

9.2 Notification of Suspected Offences or Contraventions (SOCs)

All HBR conducted in SP should follow the protocol approved by SP IRB. The PI and all related research personnel are encouraged to self-report any non-compliance during the course of the project.

Non-compliance refers to any form of failure of any member of the research team to abide by the policies and regulation governing the protection of human subjects engaged in the HBRA. Some of the examples of the non-compliance are:

- Failure to adhere to regulations, policies and procedures related to HBRA.
- Failure to obtain renewal of approval prior to change in research activities.
- Failure to obtain informed consent when required.
- Failure to report any adverse event according to the timeline and procedures stated by SP IRB.
- Failure to follow the approved research protocol.

SP IRB may receive allegation or report of non-compliance, suspected offence by a number of approaches including but not limited to:

- Voluntary report by the PI or study team member(s)
- Information provided by another staff member
- Information stated or not stated in the progress/final report
- Audit reports
- Complaints from research subjects or others
- Unreasonable reply of PI from IRB queries on the ongoing study

Any non-compliance, suspected offence or contravention will be investigated by SP IRB. For non-compliance, PI need to give explanation in protocol deviation or non-compliance report and provide corrective action if possible. Any confirmed contravention will be reported to MOH for action. When unapproved HBR activities are discovered within or outside SP campus, SP IRB and RI will act promptly to halt the research and ensure remedial actions are taken. As an immediate action, SP will form an Investigative Committee consisting of 3 members to evaluate

- (i) The cause(s) of the event.
- (ii) The harm/ potential harm imposed on the subject/ RI and to give recommendation to avoid the existence of such event.

For self-reporting, PIs can download the SOC Reporting form from SP IRB Staff Portal page and submit the completed form to SP IRB via irb@sp.edu.sg. Refer to Flowchart for Reporting SAEs and SOC at page 16.

9.3 Notification of Incidental Findings (IFs)

Incidental finding refers to a finding that has potential health or reproductive importance to the research subjects discovered in the course of conducting research but is unrelated to the purpose of the study. In the event of an incidental finding, PIs should refer to the consent given by the subject as captured in the consent form. If consent for re-identification has been given, and if approval for re-identification of the research subject has been given by SP IRB, PI should proceed to re-identify and inform the subject of the incidental finding.

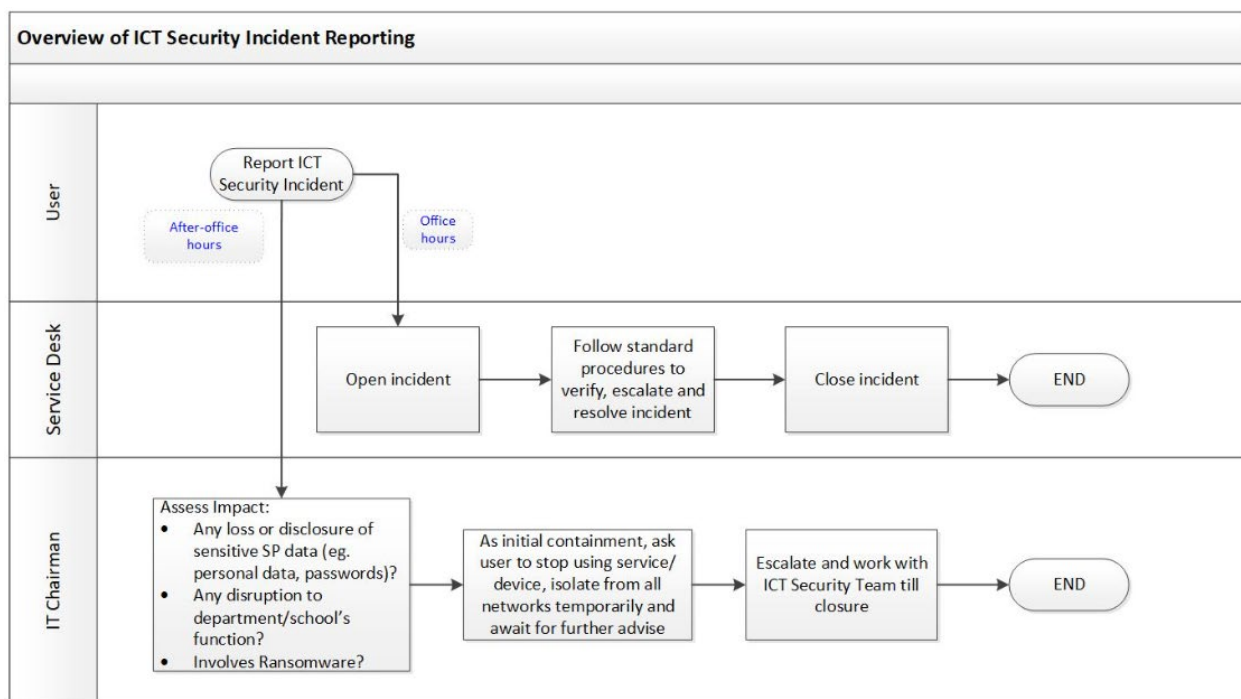
9.4 Notification of Unanticipated Events

Unanticipated events are unexpected incidents related to the participation of the study and it may lead to greater risk of harm to the subjects. PI should report unanticipated events to SP IRB within 7 days after the notification date.

9.5 Notification of Data Breach

SP has a security management programme that is built on and governed by applicable SP ICT security policies and standards. The SP ICT Security Policy and Standard is aligned with Singapore Government Instruction Manual (IM) compliance requirements. This is to ensure appropriate level of security is implemented for ICT solutions/services while remaining compliant to Government regulatory requirements. All PIs have an active responsibility in protecting SP's information assets and must comply with applicable SP ICR use policies.

PI should contact SPICE Service Desk or their school/department IT Chairman when they encounter or are aware of a security incident, e.g., virus outbreaks, website defacements, data loss/breaches, etc, and inform SP IRB within 24 hours. As a general guideline for immediate containment of the incident, PI should isolate/disconnect the affected device (e.g., notebook/laptop) from all networks and change the affected SPICE account password as soon as possible from an unaffected device. For any incident that occurs after office hours, please contact SP IRB Secretariat at 96204213.



Source: ICT Security staff portal

10 COMPOSITION OF SP IRB

SP IRB comprises of 4 external and 8 internal members appointed on a service term of 3 years. The members were selected based on their domain expertise such as law, medicine, biomedical science, food technology, vision science, nutritional science, engineering, and material science.

11. Flowchart for Reporting SAEs/SOCs

